

Microsoft and Google's staggering water consumption rates for AI

Posted by u/Alsupercharged • 0 points • 8 comments

AI, with its vast resource needs, is raising concerns over sustainability and environmental impact. Last year, Microsoft's data centers drained over 2,500 Olympic-sized swimming pools worth of water, reflecting a 34% increase from the previous year. Google also reported a 20% water consumption increase over the same period.

To stay on top of the latest advancements in AI, [look here first.](https://supercharged-ai.beehiiv.com/subscribe?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=ai-water&utm_campaign=campaign)

<https://preview.redd.it/wi83o712crnb1.png?width=990&format=png&auto=webp&s=66dee57a057fa78124a6234e41b132bd222c7c3e>

****A deeper look at AI's water footprint****

- * The growth of AI and related technologies increases the need for vast server farms, which depend heavily on water for cooling purposes.
- * The spike in water usage can be attributed primarily to AI, as per Shaolei Ren, a researcher at the UC, Riverside, who focuses on AI's environmental impact.
- * For every 5 to 50 prompts submitted to ChatGPT, it consumes about 500 ml of water, according to an upcoming paper from Professor Ren's team.

****Big Tech and Responsible Water Usage****

- * Recognizing their significant water consumption, tech companies like Google have voiced concerns and are exploring ways to mitigate the negative effects.
- * Google has committed to responsible water usage, which includes assessing where and how their water usage might affect surrounding areas.

[(source)](<https://www.independent.co.uk/tech/ai-water-energy-artificial-intelligence-b2409356.html>)

****P.S.** If you like this kind of analysis, **** I write [a free newsletter](https://supercharged-ai.beehiiv.com/subscribe?utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=ai-water&utm_campaign=campaign)** that explores the latest AI developments. Professionals

from Google, Meta, and OpenAI are already reading it.

Comments

u/Brilliant-Important • 2 points • 2023-09-12 10:36 UTC

It's sickens me the all of that wasted water just rotting in a landfill for eternity...

u/joyofsovietcooking • 2 points • 2023-09-12 09:28 UTC

OMG I don't care. Well, I do care, of course. But it's another example of shifting blame to end users instead of keeping pressure on governments and corporations to do things that would vastly help the environment.

Like what? I'm supposed to ration my f*cking prompts? How about Google turning off some f*cking servers data mining the data it sucks from my Android phone?

I'd say this was malevolent, like how we have to return to the office "to boost productivity". It feels like bosses complaining that employees are using too much ChatGPT to make their lives easier.

But IDK. I'm not rationing my prompts. I promise not to strip mine Alaska or frack a mountain for coal. That's my contribution. Your turn, ChatGPT.

u/Rude-Proposal-9600 • 2 points • 2023-09-12 08:37 UTC

If only there was a renewable resource of water that fell from the sky

u/typeryu • 4 points • 2023-09-12 08:26 UTC

This article is missing a whole ton of facts about cooling water usage in data centers. Go google the facts yourselves, but here are a few things that are known facts:

- Yes it "consumes" water, but unlike powerplants that evaporate water into steam, most of the heated water is reused after passing through cooling facilities that release heat outside.
- They don't just dump discard water into the environment, its pumped out into the waste water system where they will be treated like any other industrial water waste.
- Other industrial application like steel making is a far worse offender, but do we accuse them of water waste? Not as much because they are a necessary industry. We should treat AI the same

u/PM-ME-SOMETHING-GOOD • 12 points • 2023-09-12 06:31 UTC

>2500 Olympic-sized swimming pools

That's about 1.6 billion gallons of water in a year. That's a lot. It's about how much it would take to produce about 450 (US) tons of beef. The US consumes about 15 million tons of beef a year.

So our Microsoft data center habit uses about 0.003% as much water as our beef habit. Except Microsoft data centers serve the entire world so it's still an unfair comparison if I just include US beef consumption.

u/deccan2008 • 5 points • 2023-09-12 06:18 UTC

omg, the AIs are drinking all our water!

u/pineapplemeatloaf • 16 points • 2023-09-12 05:46 UTC

i am confused, how is this not a closed water cycle cooling system? do they just run the water until it evaporates?

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2023-09-12 05:06 UTC

Hey /u/AIsupercharged, if your post is a ChatGPT conversation screenshot, please reply with the [conversation link](<https://help.openai.com/en/articles/7925741-chatgpt-shared-links-faq>) or prompt. Thanks!

***We have a [public discord server](<https://discord.com/servers/r-chatgpt-1050422060352024636>). There's a free Chatgpt bot, Open Assistant bot (Open-source model), AI image generator bot, Perplexity AI bot, 🤖 GPT-4 bot ([Now with Visual capabilities (cloud vision)!](<https://cdn.discordapp.com/attachments/812770754025488386/1095397431404920902/image0.jpg>)) and channel for latest prompts! New Addition: Adobe Firefly bot and Eleven Labs cloning bot! [So why not join us?](<https://discord.com/servers/1050422060352024636>)**

[NEW: Google x FlowGPT Prompt Hackathon 🤖](<https://redd.it/16ehnis>)

PSA: For any Chatgpt-related issues email support@openai.com

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